



Pilgrim Paths

St Stephens, Old Radnor, LD8 2RH

3.1 mile circular walk

*Strenuous in places with climbs and descents
Kington Pilgrim Paths from St Stephens Church*

Pilgrimage

Welcome to the Kington Benefice Pilgrims Paths Project

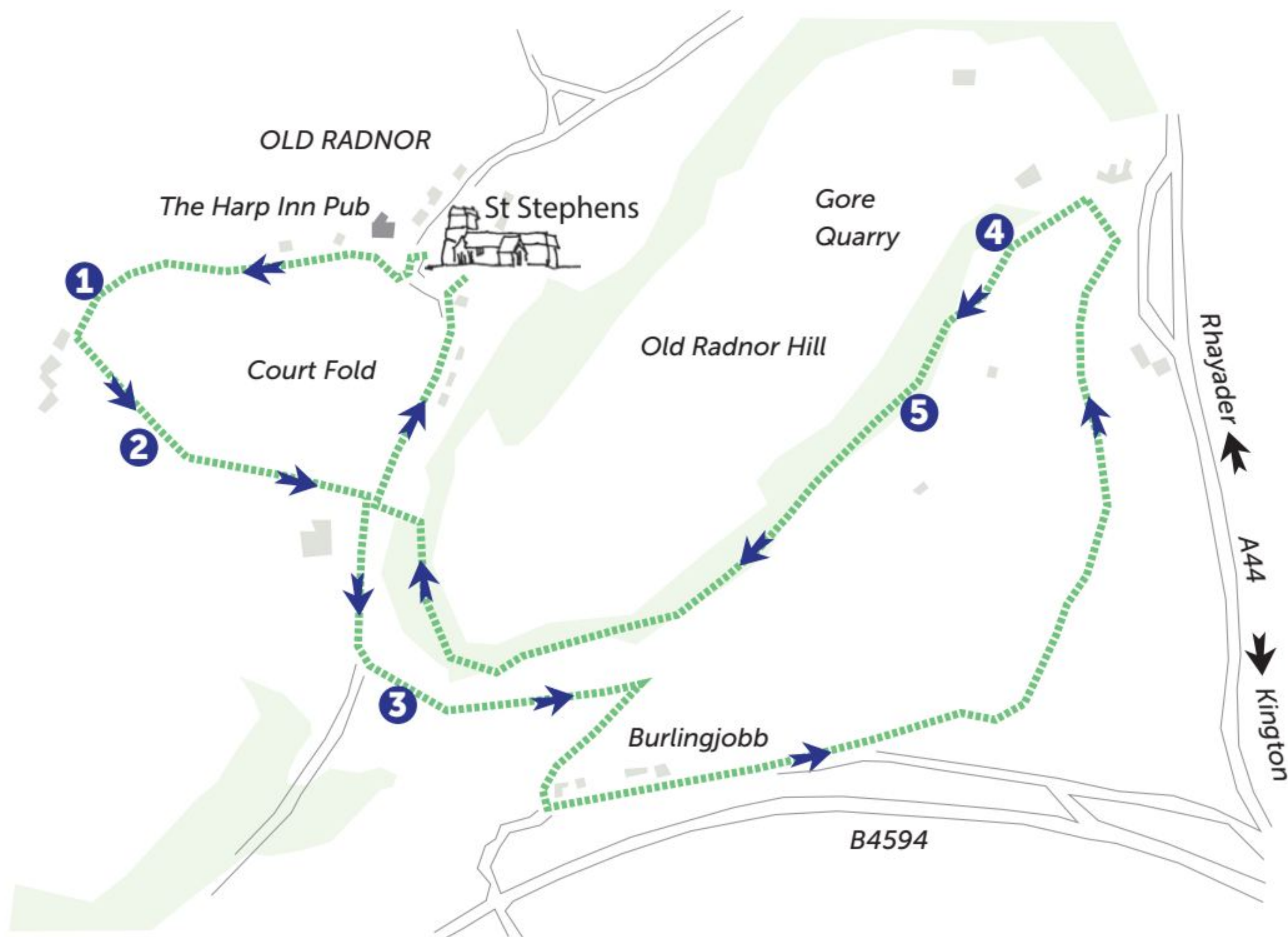
A pilgrimage is a spiritual journey to a sacred place. From earliest times, people have travelled to the 'thin places' of the world which offer opportunities for reflection and encounter. Pilgrim routes have shaped the landscape and history of this country from medieval times to the present day, as well as playing a major part in the spiritual journeys of many of its inhabitants.

The churches of the Kington Benefice offer you the hospitality of their buildings, which are open daily and the opportunity to explore the local environment along ancient ways, through outstanding landscapes.

We invite you to make this short pilgrim journey in a spirit of openness to what it might offer, delight in the countryside through which you travel and companionship with those who have travelled this way before and will do so after you.

The reflections in this leaflet are based on the Psalms, 150 ancient poems which form part of the Christian Bible. They deal with the whole range of human experience and contain much wisdom. We hope you find them a useful source of encouragement and support as you journey.

*Kington Pilgrim Paths from St Stephens Church. 5.1 km, 3.1 miles circular walk.
Strenuous in places with climbs and descents*



Look out for the Pilgrim Path
way markers around the walk



This pilgrim walk has some stunning views as well as a short stretch through Gore Quarry. Psalm 139, from which the verses are taken, is deeply reflective, inviting the reader to remember God's presence and wonder at His marvellous creation.

Turn right out of the church lych gate, right at the junction, head downhill, but carry straight on down the farm road by the telephone kiosk rather than taking the road on down the hill. Follow the farm road, past the sewage works, on to the farm.

1 Just before the farm, stop on the farm road by the galvanized gate looking NW.

"O Lord, you have searched me and known me! ... you discern my thoughts from afar." v 1-2

We can be grateful that God is Lord of all that he has created, including us. He knows us intimately! Looking NW across the Radnor Valley with its elaborate Neolithic earth works and a Roman camp, realise that God continues to know everything he has created! Looking up to the hills, the Smatcher prominent, and the Radnor Forest beyond, we can say 'Thank you Lord that your love and knowledge of us is more ancient even than the hills.'

At the farm, turn left through a galvanized gate and over another track through the second gate and up the hill. Just before the gate looking left past an ancient oak, you can see the church tower.

2 *"Where shall I go from your Spirit?
Or where shall I flee from your
presence?" v 7*

This landscape has survived over many farming generations, and heard the church bells through countless weddings, baptisms, lambing services, and of course funerals. Be still for a moment and know God's presence. Just as we are never out of his presence we are never beyond his help. Make your peace in prayer or meditation, and pass on in gratitude.

After the galvanized pedestrian gate, continue in a straight line across two fields to the road (the second field can be poached and muddy). Emerging onto a road, turn right and continue downhill to take the left hand fork. Pausing by a gate, just before a cottage on your left, look south to the hills.

3 *"You knitted me together in my
mother's womb." v 13*

In front of you is Hanter Hill; behind is the mass of Hergest, and to the left is wooded Worsell. Between the hills are old shepherd paths and tracks leading to the road, usually busy with Tarmac lorries. Do our busy lives match the plans and gifts that God laid down for us? We can ask God to help us know them and use them better.

Follow the road with the hairpin all the way down to the T junction at the bottom, ignoring left hand dead end half way down.

Turn left, follow the lane with the brook on your right until you see a galvanized gate facing you on the left. If you get to a house on your right you have gone too far - retrace your steps. Pass through the gate onto the rutted track continuing in the same direction in the field.

Follow the hedgeline through several fields. There is a small fallen tree to climb over. Pass along the inside of a shelter belt of Leylandii until you emerge in Gore Quarry.

Follow the footpath signs across the carpark towards the entrance of the Quarry.

Turn left at reception and go through a series of yellow gates to the top of the rise where there is a crossing leading downhill and crossing over to a yellow gate under a row of Leylandii. (This is simpler than it sounds; take care to respect the movements of quarry lorries who are well aware of the public right of way.)

Follow the path uphill beside the road (under the Leylandii) leading out of the quarry, shortly arriving at a small scrapyard on the left and a tiny grave yard on the right.

4 *"Wonderful are your works;
that I know very well." v 14*

With the huge machines and mountains of valuable grit stone behind you, and the intriguing scrap collection strewn ahead, the graveyard records the lives of those long since passed. Many of the lives were tragically short, but not forgotten. Consider God's works for a moment, and know that they are indeed wonderful.

Continue in the same direction on the path that has become a lane.

Continuing up the lane, stop at the top when you can look left, past an old hedgerow ash, for another view of the hills.

5 *"Search me, O God, and know my heart; ... see if there be any grievous way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting." v 23-24*

All around this huge quarry there are dilapidated farms awaiting potential expansion of the quarry. Can we make this a metaphor? Let God search your heart. Let's acknowledge the 'wicked' and perhaps 'dilapidated' ways we inevitably harbour. Lord, lead me in your ways and into your plans.

Continue uphill along the road, then down. Watch for a sign number 2 on the right marking a steep footpath right uphill. This excellent path takes you through ancient hazel coppice along the quarry fence. When the path forks, go steeply left downhill emerging at a very steep path down onto the road. Turn right to follow the road uphill to the church.



Pilgrim Paths

Kington Benefice

Pilgrimage Paths across the Benefice

The circular walks include walking on local roads, bridleways and footpaths through woods and field. There are some stiles and some moderate ascents. You may encounter sheep, cattle or horses.

Countryside code : Respect, Protect, Enjoy!

Respect other people

- *Consider the local community and other people enjoying the outdoors*
- *Leave gates and property as you find them and follow paths unless wider access is available*

Protect the natural environment

- *Leave no trace of your visit and take your litter home*
- *Keep dogs under effective control*

Enjoy the outdoors

- *Plan ahead and be prepared*
- *Follow advice and local signs.*



Kington Benefice

www.kingtonparishes.org.uk